Simon Le

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Education

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona — Faculty of Political Science and Sociology September 2026 – July 2029
PhD in Politics, Policies and International Relations

Universitat de Barcelona — Faculty of Economics and Business April 2026 – July 2026
MSc in Institutions and Political Economy

University of Washington — College of Arts & Sciences September 2022 – June 2024
BA in Political Science

Research Experience

Master Thesis: *Political Control and the Welfare State in English Councils* September 2024 – July 2026

- Executed a **regression discontinuity design** at the seat-majority threshold to measure the effect of narrow Labour majorities on local budgets
- Analyzed variation in council reliance on retained business rates to test whether elite constraints limit local welfare state expansion
- Compiled panel data of English council elections and fiscal outcomes using advanced econometric modeling

Claremont-UC Undergraduate Research Conference on the European Union April 2024

- *Welfare and Inequality Unveiled: Comparative Analysis of Governmental Accountability in Reducing Wealth Inequality in Germany and France*
- Presented original research findings at the **22nd Undergraduate Research Conference** on the EU at Scripps College, Claremont, California
- Contributed to the advancement of academic knowledge of European studies and engaged in scholarly discourse as an undergraduate student

Research in Progress

- **PhD Dissertation (in progress):** Investigating how economic elite influence and institutional constraints shape redistributive policy outcomes, with broader interests in partisan politics, welfare states, and comparative political economy using causal inference.

Research Skills

- **Econometrics:** Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) regression, diagnostic testing, Instrumental Variables (IV) estimation, Difference-in-Differences (DiD), Synthetic Control, Synthetic DiD, Fixed Effects, and Panel Data models.
- **Computational & Spatial Methods:** Machine Learning (ML), Text as Data (Natural Language Processing), Network Analysis (relational data), Geographical Information Systems (GIS), and Measurement/Classification models.

Additional Information

Languages: English (Native), Vietnamese (Native)

Programming: R, LaTeX, Excel, Python

Interests: Elites, Redistribution, Comparative Political Economy, Inequality

Scholarships: UW Jackson School of International Studies EU Center Lee Scheingold Fund